

Teaching Statement

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Economics is central to how we understand everyday decisions, public policy, and broader social outcomes. My first economics course as an undergraduate was Principles of Microeconomics, and the professor taught it in a discouraging way, with few real life applications and little room for students to share ideas. As an instructor, my commitment is to ensure that my students never feel what I felt. Teaching, to me, is not about covering a list of concepts. It is about giving students ways of thinking that they can carry forward long after the course ends.

As a graduate student at Georgia State University, I have independently designed and taught both in person and online economics courses. My first semester teaching Principles of Microeconomics ended with a 93 percent course completion rate, which rose to 98 percent the following semester in a class of 118 students. Based on student feedback, I made changes such as explaining grading expectations more clearly from the beginning and creating more opportunities for questions. My instructor preparedness rating reached 4.9 out of 5, and my communication rating increased from 4.5 to 4.7. These experiences have taught me to treat teaching as an iterative process: I pay attention to what students are struggling with, make adjustments, and evaluate whether those changes improve their learning experience.

My teaching is organized around three goals that reinforce each other. The first is building economic reasoning. Economic models and concepts can be difficult, and I believe a good instructor should make hard ideas approachable without removing their analytical content. Once students understand the underlying reasoning, they begin finding applications on their own and thinking beyond what we covered in class. In Principles of Microeconomics, for example, I asked students to connect concepts such as opportunity cost and consumer choice to their own grocery shopping and everyday decisions. Students later noted in evaluations that the course changed how they thought about real world issues, which is exactly what I aim for.

My Environmental Economics and Policy course, an upper level undergraduate elective, allowed me to extend this approach to policy questions. Throughout the course, students applied economic reasoning to debates over carbon taxes and cap and trade systems, pollution regulation, environmental externalities, and sustainable development. For the final project, each student selected a real environmental issue, applied the economic concepts and policy tools from the course, and developed an argument in writing. My goal was for students to move beyond remembering definitions and instead use economics to evaluate competing policy choices.

My second goal is communication and accessibility. Teaching more than one hundred students in an introductory course requires structure while still allowing students with different backgrounds and levels of preparation to succeed. I organize lectures and slides so that complexity builds gradually, maintain accessible office hours, provide detailed written feedback on assessments, and encourage students to ask questions throughout the course. At Georgia State, I teach a highly diverse student population, including first generation college students, students from a wide range of racial and ethnic backgrounds, students with different levels of academic preparation,

and students with accommodations. This experience has strengthened my commitment to making course design accessible from the beginning rather than treating accessibility as an adjustment made afterward.

I have also invested in learning more about universal design and online instruction. For Environmental Economics and Policy, I designed a fully asynchronous online course in which graded discussion posts encouraged students to engage with one another rather than simply move through modules independently. I also curated short videos and real world examples for each topic so that students encountered an application before working through the underlying economic model. This structure helped students come to discussions with more focused questions and made an asynchronous course feel more connected.

My third goal is engagement and active participation. In quantitative material, I often draw graphs step by step rather than placing a completed graph on a slide. Students can follow the economic logic as each component is added instead of trying to reconstruct the reasoning from a finished figure. One student told me that this approach was what finally made the material click. I use a similar philosophy in written work: students should be able to explain why an economic result follows, not simply reproduce the correct answer.

I also see teaching and mentoring as closely connected. In Environmental Economics and Policy, I provided individualized written feedback on each student's final project, and as a teaching assistant for Intermediate Microeconomics, I graded short policy essays with an emphasis on strengthening students' reasoning rather than simply marking whether an answer was correct. As faculty, I would like to build on these experiences by mentoring undergraduate and PhD students and helping them develop the analytical and quantitative skills needed for graduate study, research, and policy work.

As faculty in an economics department, I would be glad to teach core undergraduate courses such as principles of microeconomics, intermediate microeconomics, and econometrics, along with undergraduate and graduate field courses in environmental, health, and public economics. In each of these courses, my goal would be the same: to help students connect economic reasoning to real policy questions, and to keep improving my teaching through what I learn from them.